METRIC

A-A-59842
November 4, 2009

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

BELAY DEVICE, MOUNTAINEERING

This commercial item description is approved for use by the Defense Supply Center, Philadelphia and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE. This commercial item description covers the requirements for a belay device which is used to belay personnel and equipment and rappel.

2. CLASSIFICATION. The belay device will be furnished in one size.

2.1 Sizing. The belay device will conform to the sizes and characteristics as specified in Drawing 3-3-0103. The belay device will be as light-weight as possible, while meeting the standards described in the description.

3. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS. The belay/rappel device shall be designed to have three modes of operation; high friction, normal friction and auto-locking. All three modes, (Type II, Type III or Type IV) shall be possible using two Kernmantle Ropes in accordance with A-A-59835. The belay device shall be a one-piece forged construction with no rivets. The belay channels shall be designed with a smooth regular friction side and a high friction side with v-shaped grooves for added braking power. The belay device shall be capable of being used in an auto-locking mode when top roping from above. The device shall be furnished with an auto-locking release hole where an object such as a webbing runner in accordance with A-A-59840 can be used to release tension. The belay device shall have a harness retaining cable loop. The device shall have a typical carabiner in accordance with A-A-59836, attachment eye for use in the auto-locking mode. The belay device shall include permanent markings on the body that identifies the correct routing of the rope. The belay device design shall provide ease of use with typical combat gloves while meeting the standards described in the description.

Comments, suggestions, or questions on this document should be addressed to: Defense Supply Center Philadelphia, Clothing and Textiles Directorate, Attn: DSCP Standardization Team, 700 Robbins Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5096. Since contact information can change, you may want to verify the currency of this address information using Acquisition Streamlining and Standardization Information System (ASSIST) online database at http://assist.daps.dla.mil/.

AMSC N/A FSC 4240

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3.1 Color. The belay device shall be provided in a low reflectance, matte finish and provide low contrast with typical use terrain unless otherwise stated in the contract or solicitation (see 7.2).

3.2 Materials.

3.2.1 Basic material. The belay device shall be constructed from aluminum construction.

3.2.2 Retaining cable material. The retaining cable material shall be aluminum constructed

3.3 Testing. The belay device shall be able to withstand 5 falls, in accordance with the International Mountaineering and Climbing Federation, Union Internationale des Associations d'Alpinisme – (UIAA) Standard 129.

3.4 Labels. Each belay device shall have identification label Class 5 conforming to Type VI of MIL-DTL-32075. The color of the label shall be white. The following information shall be included in the printing for the identification label for the belay device.

BELAY DEVICE, MOUNTAINEERING
NSN: XXXX-XX-XXX-XXXX

The following instruction information shall be supplied:

a. the name or trademark of the manufacturer, importer or supplier
b. the meaning of any markings on the product
c. the use of the product, especially the maximum diameter of the rope with which the belay device can be used, on how to pass the rope through the device.
d. how to choose other components for use in the system
e. how to maintain and service the product
f. the lifespan of the product or how to assess it
g. the effects of chemical reagents and temperature on the product
h. the effects of storage and aging.
i. identification of the model, if more than one model is available.

3.5 Workmanship. The finished belay device shall conform to the quality of product established by this document. The occurrence of defects shall not exceed the contractors own quality assurance standards and the quality assurance standards defined in the technical data in the solicitation and/or contract.

3.6 Service life. The belay device shall have no unexpected material or component failures during a continuous one-year cycle. The belay device shall have no unexpected material or component failures during periodic use over a five year period.

3.7 Labels/barcoding/instruction slip. If applicable, all labeling, barcoding and instruction slip requirements shall be as specified in the solicitation or contract (see 7.2).

4. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials to the maximum extent practicable, in accordance with paragraph 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR).

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4.1 Recycled, recovered, or environmentally preferable materials. Recycled, recovered, or environmentally preferable materials should be used to the maximum extent possible, provided that the material meets or exceeds the operational and maintenance requirements and promotes economically advantageous life cycle costs.

5. PRODUCT CONFORMANCE PROVISIONS.

5.1 Product conformance. The products provided shall meet the salient characteristics of this Commercial Item Description, conform to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices, and be the same product offered for sale in the commercial marketplace. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance.

5.2 Visual examination. Each belay device shall be examined for the following defects as listed in Table I:

TABLE I. End item examination

Examine	Defect Description
Finish	Not smooth and adherent
	Not low reflectance, matte finish
	Does not provide low contrast with typical use terrain
Construction	Not free of burrs, rough spots, slivers, flat areas or projections
	Any component missing
	Any component fractured, slit, punctured, dented, bowed, malformed, loose or damaged
	Marking etched or indented, contains rough or sharp edges
Rope routing instructions	Incorrect, illegible, omitted or misplaced.
Labels/barcoding/instruction slip (if applicable)	Incorrect, illegible, omitted or misplaced.
Marking	Omitted, missing information or illegible
Gate	Gate does not fully close due to binding caused by interference, fit or misalignment of gate and body, or due to incorrect spring action.
	Gate pin not peened correctly (i.e., not spread evenly or uniformly in the countersunk area, peened end protrudes beyond surface or keeper, or metal breakout or cracks in peened area)
Retaining cable	Missing coating

5.3 Acceptance criteria. Acceptance criteria shall be as specified in the contract or purchase order (see 7.3).

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6. PACKAGING.

6.1 Preservation, packing and marking. The preservation, packing and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order (see 7.3).

7. NOTES.

7.1 Sources of documents.

7.1.1 Government Documents. Copies of Government documents are available online at http://assist.daps.dla.mil/quicksearch/ or from the Standardization Documents Order Desk, Building 4D, 700 Robbins Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.

DRAWINGS

U.S. ARMY NATICK SOLDIER CENTER
3-3-0103 Belay Device, Mountaineering

(Copies of drawings are available from the U.S. Army Natick Research Development and Engineering Center, Natick Soldier Center, ATTN: NSRDEC-RDNS-WPW-C, Natick, MA 01760)

7.1.2 Federal Acquisition Regulations are available online at http://acquisition.gov/far/index.html or by contacting the Superintendent of Documents at 202-512-1800.

7.2 Non-Government Documents. Non-Government standards and other publications are normally available from the organizations that prepare or distribute the documents. These documents may be available in or through libraries or other informational services.

INTERNATIONAL MOUNTAINEERING AND CLIMBING FEDERATION
UNION INTERNATIONALE DES ASSOCIATIONS D'ALPINISME (UIAA)

UIAA 129 Mountaineering and Climbing Equipment, Braking Devices

(Copies are available online at http://www.theuiaa.org or from the Union Internationale Des Associations D'Alpinisme (UIAA) Monbijoustrasse 61 Postfach CH-3000 Bern 23 Switzerland

7.3 Ordering Data. The contract or order should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this Commercial Item Description.
b. Type and size required (see 2.1).
c. When required, labeling, barcoding, and instruction slip (see 3.7)
d. Acceptance criteria (see 5.3).
e. Packaging (see 6.1).

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MILITARY INTERESTS:

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATIONG ACTIVITY:
GSA-FSS

Custodian:
Army - GL
Marine Corps – MC

PREPARING ACTIVITY:
DLA-CT

Project 4240-2009-012

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